

DRINKS BY NEAT

Running a Spirits Brand *with AI*

The Tools + Prompt Book. What to try yourself, and when to hire someone. Works with ChatGPT, Claude, and the tools named inside.

FOUR JOBS

Sales, operations, branding, content. Each worked step by step.

THE TOOLS

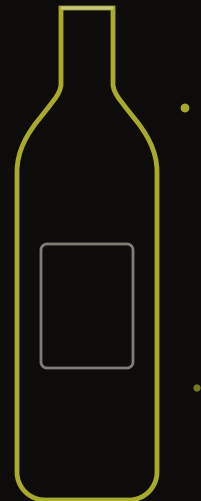
What each one does, free vs paid, and when you need it

YOUR BRAND, LOADED

One page about your brand that makes every answer fit your brand

QUICK REFERENCE

Copy-paste prompts for the rest of the week



Four jobs. One rule.

AI is easy to try and hard to make reliable. This book gives you the version you can run yourself, safely, for the four jobs a spirits brand actually has. Each job is a guided build: numbered steps, the exact message to send, and a checklist that tells you when you're done.

THE RULE

Use it *yourself* when only you see the output. *Hire someone* when customers, reps or your data are involved, or when it has to run every day without you.

NEVER USED AI BEFORE? DO THIS ONCE.

1. Open **ChatGPT or Claude**, app or website. The free version is fine to start.
2. Start a **new chat**. A chat is one conversation. The AI remembers everything inside it.
3. Copy a prompt from this book. Replace everything in **[brackets]** with your details.
4. Send it. Read the answer. Then reply with what's wrong with it. The second message is where the quality comes from.
5. During a build, **stay in the same chat** for every step.

01 Sales

Your documents answer buyer questions, with sources

02 Operations

The 7:00 brief, and assistants that work while you sell

03 Branding & new products

Test on screen before you pay for designs, samples and print

04 Content

One real bottle, many scenes

After the builds: a **quick reference** of copy-paste prompts, and one page on when to do it yourself and when to hire.

The tools in this book

You don't need all of them. Start with one chat AI. Add the others when the job calls for them.

TOOL	FREE PLAN	PAID	BEST FOR
ChatGPT CHAT AI	Yes. Daily limits on the smartest model.	~\$20/mo. Longer chats, file uploads, image making, and scheduled tasks at exact times.	Your main workbench. Builds 01 to 04, and the Monday depletions summary on a schedule.
Claude CHAT AI	Yes. Daily message limit.	~\$20/mo. Projects hold your price lists and spec sheets so every chat starts loaded. Scheduled tasks on paid plans.	Build 01. The sales assistant that answers from your own documents, and drafts distributor replies for your approval.
Grok BOTS WITH ROUTINES	Limited.	Paid plans. Each bot runs on its own computer, so routines keep running with your laptop closed.	Build 02. One bot builds the 7:00 brief, another chases follow-ups.
Threedium 3D PRODUCT	No. Platform pricing, contact them.	Project based.	Build 03. A 3D bottle from your label and bottle files. Try labels and finishes, then send buyers a QR link to spin it on their phone.
Photoroom IMAGES	Yes, with limits.	From ~\$10/mo.	Build 04. Puts your real packshot into staged scenes and keeps the product true to the original.
Chat AI images INSIDE CHATGPT / GEMINI	Yes, with limits.	Included in the ~\$20/mo plans.	Builds 03 and 04. Label mockups, mood boards, and scene concepts before you commit to anything.

Prices are ballpark, checked October 2026. Check before you subscribe.

The Brand Context File · *10 minutes, once*

One page about your brand. Paste it at the start of every chat and every answer comes back fitted to your products, your prices, your markets. This is the most useful page in the book.

How to make it

1. Open your phone's notes app.
2. Copy the four headings from the box below.
3. Fill them in. Ten minutes.
4. Paste the whole note at the top of every new AI chat, before your first question.
5. Update it when prices or products change.

Or save it once, so it's always loaded

1. **ChatGPT:** Settings, Personalization, Custom Instructions. Paste it there.
2. **Claude:** make a Project and paste it into the Project's knowledge, next to your price list and spec sheets.
3. **Gemini:** Settings, Saved Info.

Do one of these and the AI knows your brand in every chat, on every device.

1 · THE PRODUCTS

Each product on one line: name, category, ABV, bottle sizes, case format, how it's made in a few words

2 · THE NUMBERS

Case price and suggested retail by market · minimum orders · current stock position

3 · THE MARKET

Where you sell · distributors and importers by market · the accounts that matter most

4 · THE VOICE

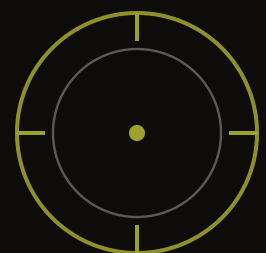
Copy in two pieces of brand writing you like, yours or anyone's. The AI will write in that style.

PART ONE

The Four Jobs

Sales, operations, branding, content. Each one worked in steps: send step 1, read the answer, send step 2. Stay in the same chat the whole way.

01 SALES · 02 OPERATIONS · 03 BRANDING & NEW PRODUCTS · 04 CONTENT



01 Put your documents to work

THE JOB A buyer asks the ABV, the case price, or the brunch serve, and the answer sits in a few heads and old PDFs. Build an assistant that answers from your real documents, for your own use.

TOOL PICK

Claude with a Project, or ChatGPT with the files attached. This build is for you and your laptop. It does not talk to customers or reps.

LOAD YOUR BRAND

Your current price list, spec sheets, allergen info, and serve guide. Current versions only. Delete the old ones first, the assistant can't tell price_list_v3 from the real thing.

1

Load the documents and set the rules

These are my brand's documents: **[ATTACH price list, spec sheets, serve guide]**. Answer only from these documents. Name the document and page with every answer. If the answer is not in them, say "not in the documents". Do not use outside knowledge for prices or specs.

WHY: the source rule is what separates a useful answer from a confident wrong one. An assistant that invents a case price costs you a sale.

2

Ask it ten real questions

I'll test you. **[ASK THE TEN QUESTIONS BUYERS ACTUALLY ASKED YOU THIS MONTH, one at a time: ABV, case price for 6, allergens, the brunch serve, lead time...]**

WHY: check every answer against the named page. Count how many were right. That number tells you whether your documents are usable or a mess.

3

Find the gaps

List every question where the documents had no answer, or where two documents disagreed. For each: which document should hold the answer.

WHY: the gaps are homework. Fix the documents, reload them, test again. Continued on the next page.

4

Build the rep FAQ

From these documents, build a one-page FAQ for my reps: the 15 questions buyers ask most, each answered in one line, with the source document and page next to it. Mark anything missing as MISSING.

WHY: a printed page in every rep's bag covers most of what the assistant covers, with zero risk.

5

Keep it current

No prompt. When a price list or spec changes: delete the old file, load the new one, re-run the ten questions. Five minutes. An assistant reading last year's price list is worse than no assistant.

THE CHECK

- **Every answer names a document and page.** No source, no answer.
- **Ten real questions tested**, answers checked against the pages it named.
- **One current version of each document loaded.** Old versions deleted.
- **Only you use it.** Nothing from this build goes in front of a customer.
- Re-tested after every price or spec change.

THE NEXT STEP IS A BUILD, NOT A PROMPT

The version your whole sales team uses lives on **WhatsApp**: reps ask from the bar, every answer carries its source, every chat is logged, and follow-ups land in a CRM. That one has to be built and maintained. If you want it for your brand, write to me: sani@drinksbyneat.com

02 The 7:00 brief

THE JOB Sales calls, orders, stock counts, invoices, distributor emails. Admin eats the day and follow-ups slip. Set assistants that work while you sell.

TOOL PICK

ChatGPT or Claude scheduled tasks (paid plans; ChatGPT for exact times). **Grok bots** for routines that keep running with your laptop closed. One rule across all of it: assistants read and draft. They never send.

LOAD YOUR BRAND

Your follow-up list, your par levels by account, and whatever report your distributor sends. Connect your inbox only on a paid plan you trust with it.

1

Set the morning brief

Every weekday at 7:00: one brief. What's due today from my follow-up list **[PASTE OR CONNECT]**, what's handled, which accounts have gone quiet for 30 days or more, and the 3 things that need me before my first call. Plain list.

WHY: set it once as a scheduled task and it runs every morning. You decide before the first call instead of discovering at 16:00.

2

Set the Monday depletions summary

Every Monday at 8:00, I'll attach last week's depletion report. Summarise by account and product, flag accounts below par **[PASTE PAR LEVELS]** or trending down two weeks in a row, and give me this week's call list in order.

WHY: the report already exists. The reading of it is what never happens. This makes the reading automatic.

3

Draft the distributor replies

Draft replies to these distributor emails: **[PASTE]**. Use only my price list and stock notes **[PASTE]** for numbers. Flag anything I must decide myself. Leave every reply as a draft for my approval. Continued on the next page.

4

Write down who approves what

No prompt. One line on paper: "Drafts to distributors: I approve. Orders and invoices: humans only." Decide it before the first assistant runs, not after the first mistake.

WHY: the three ways this goes wrong are confident wrong answers, out-of-date prices, and things sent without a check. The approval line blocks the worst one.

5

Review after one month

Here's what the brief missed this month and what it flagged that didn't matter: **[YOUR NOTES]**. Rewrite the brief's instructions to fix both.

WHY: a brief that cries wolf gets ignored by week three. Tune it once and it stays read.

THE CHECK

- **Nothing sends, orders, or invoices on its own.** Drafts wait for you.
- **Every number comes from your documents,** and the draft says which one.
- **The brief arrives before your first call,** and you actually read it.
- Who approves what is written down.
- **When it has to send or order without you,** that's a hire, not a prompt.

03 Test before you print

THE JOB Designs, samples, print runs and photography are all paid before you know they work. Test on screen first, pay for the one that survives.

TOOL PICK

Your **chat AI** for directions and mockups (image mode included in ChatGPT and Gemini). **Threedium** for the real 3D bottle buyers can spin on their phone. The 3D model and the buyer link are a build: hire for that step.

LOAD YOUR BRAND

The product and its story, your current label files and a straight-on bottle photo, and where it will sit on the shelf: which store, next to which bottles, at what price.

1

Directions before designs

You are a packaging designer for spirits. For **[PRODUCT + STORY]**, sitting on a shelf next to **[THE BOTTLES AROUND IT]** at **[PRICE]**: give me 5 label directions. For each: mood, colors, type style, and one line on how it reads from 3 meters away. No images yet.

WHY: shelf distance is the test that matters. A label that only works in your hand loses at retail.

2

Mock up the shortlist

Direction **[N]**. Make the label concept as an image: **[FORMAT AND SIZE]**, no brand names from real spirits, space for the legal text. Then show it on a **[BOTTLE SHAPE]** bottle at shelf distance, between **[COMPETITOR BOTTLE SHAPES AND COLORS]**.

WHY: a mockup costs nothing. A design round, a sample and a print run cost up front, before you know it works.

3

Put your real label on

Here is my actual label file and bottle photo: **[ATTACH]**. Put the label on the bottle exactly as designed. Change nothing on the label. Show shelf distance and full zoom. Continued on the next page.

4

The 3D bottle buyers can hold

No prompt. **Threedium** builds a 3D bottle from your label and bottle files. You try labels and finishes on it, then send buyers a QR link to view it on their phone. This step and the buyer link are a build job: have it done for you.

WHY: a buyer spinning your bottle on their phone is the closest thing to a sample that costs nothing to ship.

5

Only then pay

No prompt. Samples, the design round, and the print run go to the one direction that survived the shelf test and the 3D bottle. You pay once, for the winner.

THE CHECK

- **Nothing goes to print that wasn't tested at shelf distance** next to its real competitors.
- **The label in every buyer-facing image is your real file**, legible at full zoom.
- **Mockups are for deciding, not for buyers.** Buyers get the real label or the 3D bottle.
- Legal text, ABV and volume statements checked on the final file by a human.

NAMED ON STAGE

Threedium (threedium.com) is the 3D product platform from the talk. The model and buyer link are project work: contact them, or write to me and I'll point you right: sani@drinksbyneat.com

04 One bottle, many scenes

THE JOB You can't shoot a photoshoot for every post. The real bottle is always the source. AI builds the scene around it.

TOOL PICK

Photoroom places your real packshot into staged scenes and keeps the product true to the original. Your chat AI's image mode works for concepts. Captions: your chat AI, with your voice samples loaded.

LOAD YOUR BRAND

One good packshot (next step), your serve specs, and the two pieces of brand writing from your Brand Context File.

1

Shoot one good packshot

No prompt. Phone on a tripod, daylight, plain background, label straight to camera, highest resolution. This one photo is the source for every scene that follows.

2

Build the scenes around it

In Photoroom or your image tool: Place my packshot **[ATTACH]** into **[SCENE: a bar counter at night / a brunch table / an outdoor terrace / a retail shelf]**. Keep the bottle and label exactly as the photo. Match the scene's lighting on the bottle. No people, no faces.

WHY: the real bottle is the one thing that must never be AI. Guests forgive a generated backdrop. They don't forgive a fake label.

3

Run the bar-craft check

Check this image like a bartender would: is the glassware right for **[THE SERVE]**, does the ice look real, does the label read at full zoom, are there any hands or faces? List what fails. Continued on the next page.

WHY: trade people spot a wrong glass in half a second. The check takes ten.

4

Write the captions in your voice

Write 5 captions for this image: one fact-led, one with the full serve spec (every quantity with its unit and ingredient on the same line), one trade-facing, one short, one for **[OCCASION]**. My voice, from these samples: **[PASTE 2]**. Three hashtags maximum.

WHY: the voice samples are what keep it from sounding like every other AI caption on the feed.

5

Plan the month

Build a one-month plan for **[CHANNELS]**: 3 posts a week mixing serves, trade and story. For each post: the scene to build or shot to take, a caption draft, and the checks before posting: label at full zoom, right glassware, no faces.

WHY: the plan turns one packshot into a month of posts, each with its check built in.

THE CHECK

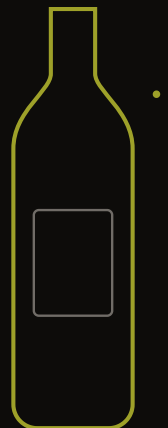
- **The bottle in every image is your real bottle.** AI builds the scene, never the product.
- **No AI faces.** Ever.
- **The label reads at full zoom** on every image you post.
- **Serve specs carry units and ingredient on the same line.**
- A human approves every post. The monthly pipeline with brand checks is a hire when you can't be that human.

PART TWO

The Quick Reference

Copy-paste prompts for the rest of the week. Each one works on its own. They work better with your Brand Context File pasted first.

SALES · OPERATIONS · BRANDING · CONTENT



SALES

S1 The ten-question test

TOOL · CLAUDE PROJECT OR CHATGPT WITH FILES

I've attached my price list and spec sheets. I'll ask ten questions buyers ask. Answer each only from these documents, name the document and page for every answer, and say "not in the documents" when it isn't there. No outside knowledge for prices or specs.

S2 Rep FAQ with sources

TOOL · SAME CHAT AS S1

From these documents, build a one-page FAQ for my reps: the 15 questions buyers ask most (ABV, case prices, formats, allergens, lead times, serves), each answered in one line with the source document and page next to it. Mark gaps as MISSING.

S3 Quiet accounts

TOOL · ANY CHAT AI

Here's my account list with last order dates: [PASTE]. Flag every account quiet for 30 days or more, rank them by usual order size, and draft a short check-in message for the top 5 in my voice: [PASTE A SAMPLE]. Under 60 words each.

S4 One-page sell sheet

TOOL · CHATGPT OR CLAUDE

Write a one-page sell sheet for [PRODUCT]. Facts: [SPECS + STORY + PRICES + FORMATS]. Sections: what it is, how it's made in two lines, 3 things a rep can say at the bar, 2 serves with full specs (quantity, unit and ingredient on the same line), case formats and price. Plain language.

S5 Trade show follow-ups

TOOL · ANY CHAT AI

I met these people at [EVENT]: [NAME, VENUE, WHAT WE DISCUSSED, one per line]. Draft a follow-up for each: reference what we discussed, one clear next step, under 80 words, my voice: [SAMPLE]. Flag which ones asked for prices so I attach the list.

OPERATIONS

01 The morning brief

TOOL · CHATGPT OR CLAUDE SCHEDULED TASK (PAID)

Every weekday at 7:00: one brief. What's due today from my follow-up list, what's handled, which accounts or threads have gone quiet for 30 days or more, and the 3 things that need me before my first call. Plain list.

02 Monday depletions

TOOL · SCHEDULED TASK + WEEKLY REPORT

Every Monday at 8:00, I'll attach the depletion report. Summarise last week by account and product, flag accounts below par [PASTE PARS] or down two weeks running, and list who to call this week, in order.

03 Distributor reply drafts

TOOL · ANY CHAT AI, DRAFTS ONLY

Draft replies to these emails: [PASTE]. Numbers only from my price list and stock notes: [PASTE]. Flag anything I must decide myself. Every reply stays a draft for my approval. Never assume a price that isn't in my documents.

04 Order check

TOOL · ANY CHAT AI, THEN YOUR OWN CHECK

Here's an order: [PASTE] and my price list: [PASTE]. Check every line: quantity, price, discount. Show the math per line. List every line that doesn't match the price list. Then recompute the total from scratch and tell me if it changed.

BRANDING & NEW PRODUCTS

B1 Label directions

TOOL · ANY CHAT AI

You are a packaging designer for spirits. For **[PRODUCT + STORY]**, shelved next to **[COMPETITORS]** at **[PRICE]**: 5 label directions. Each: mood, colors, type style, one line on how it reads from 3 meters. No images yet.

B2 Shelf test

TOOL · CHAT AI IMAGE MODE

Show my label concept **[ATTACH]** on a **[BOTTLE SHAPE]** bottle, on a retail shelf at 3 meters, between **[COMPETITOR SHAPES AND COLORS]**. Keep my label exactly as designed. Then the same shot at arm's length.

B3 Name check

TOOL · CHAT AI WITH WEB SEARCH ON

I'm naming a new **[CATEGORY]**. Candidates: **[LIST, or ask for 10]**. For each: existing spirits using the name or close to it, trademark risks to check with a lawyer, and what the word means in **[MARKET LANGUAGES]**.

B4 Mood board

TOOL · CHAT AI IMAGE MODE

Mood board for **[DIRECTION]**: materials, textures, colors and settings that carry it. Flat lighting, no text, no bottles from real brands, one image, grid of 9.

CONTENT

C1 Packshot into a scene

TOOL · PHOTOROOM, OR CHAT AI IMAGE MODE

Place my packshot **[ATTACH]** into **[SCENE: bar counter at night / brunch table / outdoor terrace / retail shelf]**. Keep the bottle and label exactly as the photo. Match the scene's light on the bottle. No people, no faces.

C2 Bar-craft check

TOOL · ANY CHAT AI, ATTACH THE IMAGE

Check this image like a bartender: right glassware for **[SERVE]**, real-looking ice, label legible at full zoom, no hands or faces, nothing physically impossible on the bar. List what fails and what to regenerate.

C3 Caption batch

TOOL · CHAT AI WITH VOICE SAMPLES

5 captions for this image **[ATTACH + THE SERVE]**: fact-led, full serve spec (quantity, unit and ingredient on the same line), trade-facing, short, and one for **[OCCASION]**. Voice from these samples: **[PASTE 2]**. Three hashtags maximum.

C4 Month of posts

TOOL · CHATGPT OR CLAUDE

One-month plan for **[CHANNELS]**: 3 posts a week mixing serves, trade and story. Per post: scene to build or shot to take, caption draft in my voice **[SAMPLE]**, and the pre-post checks: label at full zoom, right glassware, no faces.

C5 Serve spec post

TOOL · ANY CHAT AI

Write the recipe post for **[SERVE]**: ingredients with quantity, unit and ingredient on the same line, method in numbered steps, no commentary between steps. Round the numbers. End with one plain line on where to find the product.

Do it yourself, or hire someone?

Yourselves when only you see the output. Hire when customers, reps or your data are involved, or when it has to run every day without you.

JOB	DO IT YOURSELF	HIRE SOMEONE TO BUILD AND MAINTAIN
Sales	Ask an assistant about your own sheets (Build 01)	A rep assistant on WhatsApp with sources and CRM logs
Operations	A morning brief on your own inbox (Build 02)	Anything that sends, orders or invoices
Branding	Mock-up labels and mood boards (Build 03)	The 3D model and the buyer link
Content	Scenes and captions with a checklist (Build 04)	A monthly pipeline with brand checks

Why the rule exists

AI gives confident wrong answers. The fix: every answer names its source, and you click it.

Prices go out of date. The fix: current documents only, reloaded when they change.

Things get sent without a check. The fix: drafts wait for a human, and who approves what is written down.

When the stakes are a customer, a rep, or your data, the fixes above need logs, testing and maintenance. That's a build, not a prompt.

DRINKS BY NEAT

Pick one job.
Try it yourself.
Hire someone for the rest.

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